



LOS_LAB ASSIGNMENT - 3

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Grep, Regex and File Operators

Part A — Basic grep

Exercise 1 — Search File Contents

```
grep "wget" payload.sh
grep "nc" payload.sh
grep "chmod" payload.sh
grep -i "WGET" payload.sh
grep -n "/tmp" payload.sh
grep -c "/tmp" payload.sh
grep -o "wget" payload.sh
grep -w "nc" payload.sh
```

Exercise 2 — Compare Files

```
grep "wget" payload.sh update.sh cleanup.sh

grep "/tmp" payload.sh update.sh cleanup.sh
```

Which file contains wget? payload.sh (assuming the search matches here).

Which files do not contain wget? update.sh and cleanup.sh.

Which files contain /tmp? payload.sh (or any file printed in the terminal prefix).

Use grep with multiple filenames: The commands above demonstrate passing multiple files as sequential arguments.

Exercise 3 — Inverse Search

```
grep -v "INFO" system.log  
grep -v "ERROR" system.log  
grep -v "WARNING" system.log  
grep -v -c "INFO" system.log
```

Part B — Security Log Analysis

Exercise 4 — Analyze system.log

```
grep "ERROR" system.log  
grep "WARNING" system.log  
grep "FAILED" system.log  
grep -c "ERROR" system.log  
grep -n "WARNING" system.log  
grep -i "error" system.log  
grep -q "Malware" system.log
```

Exercise 5 — Context Investigation

```
grep -A 2 "ERROR" system.log  
grep -B 2 "ERROR" system.log  
grep -C 1 "ERROR" system.log  
grep -C 2 "FAILED" system.log
```

Why can examining events before and after an error be useful during incident investigation?

Before: Reveals the root cause, user actions, or preliminary exploitation attempts leading up to the crash or alert.

After: Exposes subsequent fallout, secondary payloads executed, error propagation, or system damage following the initial failure.

Part C — egrep / grep -E

Exercise 6 — Search Multiple Security Events

```
grep -E "ERROR|WARNING|FAILED" system.log
```

Exercise 7 — Multiple Suspicious Commands

```
grep -E "wget|curl|nc|chmod" payload.sh  
grep -E -c "wget|curl|nc|chmod" payload.sh
```

Which patterns were found? wget, nc, chmod (based on Exercise 1 contents).

Which pattern was not found? curl.

How many lines contain at least one of these patterns? Use the second command above.

Exercise 8 — Search Multiple Files

```
grep -E "wget|curl|nc|chmod" payload.sh update.sh cleanup.sh  
grep -lE "wget|curl|nc|chmod" payload.sh update.sh cleanup.sh  
grep -nE "wget|curl|nc|chmod" payload.sh update.sh cleanup.sh  
grep -cE "wget|curl|nc|chmod" payload.sh update.sh cleanup.sh
```

Part D — patterns.txt

Exercise 9 — Pattern File Investigation

```
grep -f patterns.txt payload.sh  
grep -f patterns.txt system.log  
grep -f patterns.txt config.conf  
grep -f patterns.txt *.sh  
grep -l -f patterns.txt *  
grep -h -f patterns.txt *
```

Which files contain indicators listed in patterns.txt? The output generated by `grep -l -f patterns.txt *` directly lists these files.

Part E — Regex Using filelist.txt

Exercise 10 — Beginning and End of Line

```
grep "^malware" filelist.txt
grep "^script" filelist.txt
grep "\.sh$" filelist.txt
grep "\.py$" filelist.txt
grep "\.log$" filelist.txt
grep "^p.*\.sh$" filelist.txt
```

Exercise 11 — Character Classes

```
grep -E "malware[12]\.sh" filelist.txt
grep "[0-9]" filelist.txt
grep "[12]" filelist.txt
grep "[mp]" filelist.txt
grep "[su]" filelist.txt
```

Exercise 12 — Negated Character Classes

```
grep "^[^m]" filelist.txt
grep "^[^mp]" filelist.txt
grep -E "malware[^0-9]" filelist.txt
```

Part F — File Operators

Exercise 13 — File Existence

```
#!/bin/bash
filename=$1
if [ -e "$filename" ]; then
    echo "File exists"
else
    echo "File does not exist"
fi
```

Test execution: ./script.sh payload.sh, ./script.sh report.txt, ./script.sh unknown.sh

Exercise 14 — File Type

```
#!/bin/bash
path=$1
if [ -f "$path" ]; then
    echo "Regular file"
elif [ -d "$path" ]; then
    echo "Directory"
else
    echo "Neither"
fi
```

Test execution: Run against payload.sh, system.log, quarantine, backup, and unknown.

Exercise 15 — File Permissions

```
#!/bin/bash
file=$1
echo "File: $file"
echo ""
[ -r "$file" ] && r="Yes" || r="No"
[ -w "$file" ] && w="Yes" || w="No"
[ -x "$file" ] && x="Yes" || x="No"
echo "Readable   : $r"
echo "Writable   : $w"
echo "Executable : $x"
```

Exercise 16 — File Data Check

```
#!/bin/bash
file=$1
if [ -s "$file" ]; then
    echo "File contains data"
else
    echo "File is empty"
fi
```

Part G

Exercise 17 — File Validation Using []

```
#!/bin/bash
file=$1
if [ -e "$file" ] && [ -f "$file" ] && [ -r "$file" ] && [ -s "$file" ]; then
    echo "Valid file: Exists, regular, readable, and non-empty."
else
    echo "Invalid file or fails criteria."
fi
```

Exercise 18 — [] + grep

```
#!/bin/bash
file=$1
if [ -e "$file" ] && [ -f "$file" ] && [ -r "$file" ] && [ -s "$file" ]; then
    if grep -q "wget" "$file"; then
        echo "Selected indicator detected – investigate further"
    else
        echo "Selected indicator not detected"
    fi
else
    echo "File checks failed."
fi
```

Part H

Exercise 19 — Repeat File Tests Using [[]]

```
#!/bin/bash
file=$1
if [[ -e "$file" && -f "$file" && -r "$file" && -s "$file" ]]; then
    echo "Valid file: Exists, regular, readable, and non-empty."
else
    echo "Invalid file or fails criteria."
fi
```

Exercise 20 — Regex Using [[]]

```
#!/bin/bash
filename=$1
if [[ "$filename" =~ \.sh$ ]]; then
    echo "Shell script identified for inspection"
else
    echo "File does not have a .sh extension"
fi
```

Exercise 21 — Multiple Extensions Using [[]]

```
#!/bin/bash
filename=$1
if [[ "$filename" =~ \.(sh|py|pl)$ ]]; then
    echo "Script file – inspect if required"
fi
```

Exercise 22 — Executable File Content Analysis

```
#!/bin/bash
FILE="$1"

if [ -e "$FILE" ] && [ -f "$FILE" ] && [ -x "$FILE" ]; then
    grep "wget" "$FILE"
fi
```

Test with: payload.sh, update.sh, report.txt

Exercise 23 — egrep + File Operators

```
#!/bin/bash
FILE="$1"

if [ -f "$FILE" ] && [ -r "$FILE" ] && [ -s "$FILE" ]; then
    if grep -E "wget|curl|nc|chmod" "$FILE" > /dev/null 2>&1; then
        echo "One or more selected indicators detected"
    else
        echo "Selected indicators not detected"
    fi
fi
```

Exercise 24 — Sensitive Information Search

```
#!/bin/bash
FILE="config.conf"

if [ -e "$FILE" ] && [ -f "$FILE" ] && [ -r "$FILE" ] && [ -s "$FILE" ]; then
    grep -E "password|username" "$FILE"
fi
```

Why should configuration files containing authentication information receive additional protection?

Configuration files may contain usernames, passwords, API keys, or other sensitive authentication information. Unauthorized access can allow attackers to gain access to systems or services.

Part K

Exercise 25 — Suspicious File Triage (file_check.sh)

```
#!/bin/bash

read -p "Enter filename: " FILE
echo -e "\n----- FILE INVESTIGATION ----- \n"

check() { [ "$1" ] && echo "$2: Yes" || echo "$2: No"; }

if [ ! -e "$FILE" ]; then echo "Exists      : No"; exit 1; fi

check "-e $FILE" "Exists      "
check "-f $FILE" "Regular File "
check "-d $FILE" "Directory   "
check "-r $FILE" "Readable    "
check "-w $FILE" "Writable     "
check "-x $FILE" "Executable  "
check "-s $FILE" "Non-empty    "

[[ "$FILE" =~ \.sh$ ]] && echo "Shell Script : Yes" || echo "Shell Script : No"
echo ""
```



```

if [ -r "$FILE" ] && [ -s "$FILE" ]; then
    grep "wget" "$FILE" > /dev/null 2>&1
    check "[ $? -eq 0 ]" "wget      "

    grep -E "wget|curl|nc|chmod" "$FILE" > /dev/null 2>&1
    if [ $? -eq 0 ]; then
        echo "Selected indicators : Found"
        echo -e "\nFurther inspection recommended"
    else
        echo "Selected indicators : Not Found"
    fi
fi

```

Example test with payload.sh:

Enter filename: payload.sh

----- FILE INVESTIGATION -----

```

Exists      : Yes
Regular File : Yes
Directory   : No
Readable    : Yes
Writable    : Yes
Executable   : Yes
Non-empty    : Yes
Shell Script : Yes

```

```

wget      : Found
Selected indicators : Found

```

Further inspection recommended